

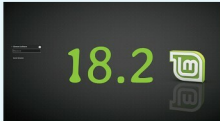
Linux Mint 18.2 'Sonya' gets released in Cinnamon, KDE, MATE and Xfce editions

Linux Mint 18.2 Sonya is finally out. The development team has released the new version five months after releasing the Serena variant of the Mint platform.

The original edition of Linux Mint 18.2 comes with the Cinnamon 3.4 desktop environment. There are also some other additions like Xed, Xviewer, Xreader, XPlayer, Blueberry, Pix, Update Manager, Software Sources, and LightDM as a display manager.

Apart from the new additions, the existing packages have been upgraded to their latest versions. Another welcome change in Linux Mint 18.2 Sonya is the new greeter, called Slack. Besides, there are plenty of new wallpaper and artworks contributed by the Linux Mint community.

Linux Mint 18.2 Sonya is released in the Cinnamon, KDE, MATE and Xfce editions. The KDE edition of the distro has the Plasma 5.8 desktop environment while the MATE edition includes MATE 1.18 desktop. The Xfce edition, on the other hand, comes with the Xfce 4.12 environment.



It is worth noting that Linux 18.2 is an LTS release, designed to receive support until 2021. The distro has Linux 4.8 and is based on Ubuntu 16.04.

The latest Linux Mint distro is offered in the 32-bit and 64-bit editions. You can download its ISOs from the official website. Also, you can use the Update Manager application to upgrade your Linux Mint installation to the latest version or use bootable media to perform a clean install.

Microsoft plans AI for devices even tinier than Raspberry Pi

While the artificial intelligence (AI) market is getting bigger, Microsoft has revealed plans to build a computer-vision model for hardware that's even tinier than a Raspberry Pi.

An early preview of Microsoft's Embedded Learning Library (ELL), which has been released on GitHub, is designed to initiate the process of bringing AI to miniature devices. The software is supposedly capable of embedding AI onto bread-crumbs size computer processors to enable an entirely new class of machine learning.



Offer Dekel, who manages the machine learning and optimisation group at Microsoft's research lab in Redmond, is leading the team of 30 computer scientists, software engineers and research interns in Redmond and Bengaluru to take the latest development to its final stage. This project is expected to populate the world with small-sized intelligent devices. Also, the hardware that jointly builds the Internet of Things (IoT) would turn into a standalone solution that will work in tandem with humans.

"Pushing machine learning to edge devices reduces bandwidth constraints and eliminates concerns about network latency, which is the time it takes for data to travel to the cloud for processing and back to the device," Microsoft's John Roach wrote in a blog post.

The engineering teams at Microsoft's research labs are planning to deploy machine learning on devices powered by ARM Cortex M7 and even Cortex M0 processors.

Dekel and his army are set to adopt top-down and bottom-up approaches. The former is targeted at developing algorithms that compress machine learning models trained for the cloud and involves devices like Raspberry Pi 3 and Raspberry Pi Zero. Whereas, the bottom-up model is to bring the same intelligent experience on resource-constrained devices that is available today for computers and servers.

The tiniest device that has been tested to enable machine learning is 2KB RAM-powered Arduino Uno. Dekel has already deployed the initial model on a Raspberry Pi 3 that helps it switch on the sprinkler system in his yard once it detects a squirrel. Other makers are expected to work on solving different problems through the latest development.

Meanwhile, you can access the ELL code from its GitHub repository. The library supports a large list of embedded platforms such as Raspberry Pi, Arduino, BBC micro:bits and some microcontrollers. Besides, APIs are provided in C++ and Python to ease development.

Sony joins open source AI space

Sony has joined the bandwagon of open source artificial intelligence (AI) by releasing the code of its proprietary deep learning framework 'Neural Network Libraries'. The latest move is aimed at expanding the development of deep learning programs.

The Neural Network Libraries framework supports dynamic and static computation graphs. The libraries also support functions, optimisers and operators for neural networks. The framework is written in C++11. However, developers can access the code using C++11 or fetch the data using the Python API.

"Sony's R&D Platform and System R&D Group have used these core libraries